Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-

First Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination November 2025

Multi-Disciplinary Courses - MG1MDCSWK100 - Social Science Perspectives For Social Analysis**-**

QP CODE: **25900957-**

Duration: 1 Hour

Maximum Marks: 35

Part A Short Answer Questions Answer any five questions / each question carries 3 marks

1	Define reason in your words a. **Reason is the ability to think logically** and make judgments based on evidence. b. **It helps distinguish facts from emotions or biases.** c. **Reason guides rational decision-making** and understanding of the world	[K] / [CO1] 3 marks
2	Identify two key characteristics of a community a. **Common identity or sense of belonging** among members. b. **Regular social interaction** that builds relationships and cooperation.	U] / [CO1 3 marks
3	Describe the relationship between democracy and human rights a. **Democracy protects human rights** by ensuring freedom, equality, and rule of law. b. **Human rights strengthen democracy** by empowering people to participate and express opinions. c. **Both depend on each other**—without human rights, democracy becomes authoritarian; without democracy, rights are vulnerable.	[U] / [CO3] 3 marks
4	Describe the idea of 'criticising traditional authority' in modernity? a. **Modernity questions inherited beliefs** instead of accepting them blindly. b. **Rational thinking and scientific inquiry** replace tradition as the basis of truth. c. **Individuals gain autonomy** to challenge customs, religion, hierarchy, and old power structures.	[U] / [CO1, CO2] 3 marks
5	Write two social science perspectives on social problems a. **Structural-Functionalist perspective** – Social problems emerge when institutions fail to function properly. b. **Conflict perspective** – Problems arise from inequality, power struggles, and exploitation. c. **Symbolic Interactionist perspective** – Problems exist when society *labels* certain behaviors or groups as problematic.	[U] / [CO1] 3 marks
6	What are the primary agents of socialization? a. F**amily** – foundational values, language, behaviour patterns. b. **School and peers** – discipline, social skills, teamwork, norms. c. **Media and community** – exposure to culture, ideas, and wider society.	[K] / [CO1] 3 marks
7	Define Scepticism a. **Scepticism means questioning claims** instead of accepting them blindly. b. **It involves demanding evidence** before believing something. c. **Scepticism promotes critical thinking** and protects against misinformation.	[U] / [CO1, CO2] 3 marks

Part B Essay Questions Answer any 2 Questions Each Question carries 10 marks

8	Analyse the effect of social oppression on marginalized groups and suggest ways to address it 1. **Psychological and Emotional Trauma**. 2. **Limited Access to Resources and Opportunities** 3. **Social Exclusion and Isolation** 4. **Intergenerational Disadvantage** **5. Loss of Cultural Identity and Voice** **<u>Important Ways to Address Social Oppression</u>** 1. **Legal and Policy Reforms**	[An] / [CO2] 5 marks 5 marks

	2. **Inclusive Education and Awareness Programs** 3. **Empowerment Through Community Development** 4. **Improved Access to Social and Economic Resources** 5. **Promoting Representation and Voice**	
9	Describe the role of culture in shaping individual behavior and societal norms. a. **Defines acceptable behavior** – Culture sets rules about what is right, wrong, normal, or deviant. b. **Shapes identity** – Language, traditions, and rituals form the basis of personal and group identity. c. **Influences thinking patterns** – Cultural values guide how individuals interpret events and make decisions. d. **Regulates social interactions** – Norms of respect, gender roles, and communication styles reflect cultural expectations. e. **Provides shared meanings** – Symbols, beliefs, and stories help people understand their world collectively. f. **Guides emotional expression** – Culture determines how people express joy, grief, anger, or affection. g. **Transmits values across generations** – Socialization ensures continuity of customs, beliefs, and norms. h. **Shapes institutions** – Family, religion, education, and law reflect cultural values. i. **Promotes social cohesion** – Common cultural practices build unity and belonging. j. **Can reinforce inequality** – Culture may also maintain patriarchy, caste hierarchy, or exclusion unless challenged.	[K] / [CO5] 10 marks
10	Explain the importance of the ideas of reason and freedom in human life and how these ideas would contribute to social change 1. **Reason enables critical thinking** – It helps individuals question outdated beliefs and avoid blind obedience. 2. **Promotes scientific understanding** – Rational inquiry leads to innovation and problem-solving. 3. **Freedom allows self-expression** – Individuals can explore ideas, aspirations, and creativity. 4. **Supports moral autonomy** – People make ethical choices based on judgment rather than coercion. 5. **Breaks traditional authority** – Reason challenges oppressive customs, superstition, and hierarchical norms. 6. **Encourages democratic values** – Freedom of speech and thought strengthens civic participation. 7. **Drives social reform** – Movements for equality, human rights, and justice emerge from rational critique. 8. **Enhances personal development** – Reason and freedom support education, skill-building, and self-actualization. 9. **Promotes tolerance and dialogue** – Rational debate reduces violence and fosters peaceful coexistence. 10. **Together they create progressive societies** – When people think freely and act autonomously, social transformation becomes possible.	[K] / [CO1] 10 marks
11	Examine the role of education in empowering Dalit and Adivasi communities in overcoming social barriers. 1. **Breaks caste- and tribe-based stereotypes** – Education challenges prejudices that justify discrimination. 2. **Enhances economic mobility** – Access to schooling improves employment opportunities and income levels. 3. **Builds self-confidence and agency** – Education empowers individuals to assert their rights and identity. 4. **Improves political participation** – Educated Dalit and Adivasi citizens engage more effectively in democratic processes. 5. **Strengthens awareness of constitutional rights** – Knowledge of protections (e.g., SC/ST Act) reduces vulnerability. 6. **Promotes social integration** – Schools serve as spaces where children from different backgrounds interact. 7. **Encourages leadership development** – Skilled individuals become community leaders, activists, and role models. 8. **Reduces exploitation** – Educated individuals are better able to resist bonded labor, land alienation, and social abuse. 9. **Supports preservation of cultural identity** – Inclusive education values tribal languages, traditions, and knowledge systems. 10. **Acts as a long-term equalizer** – Education gradually transforms social structures, weakening caste hierarchy and exclusion.	[A] / [CO6] 10 marks